AIDCF

AI Data Centre Facilities Assurance Framework

ASSURANCE PROGRAM FRAMEWORK

Version 1.0

A non-certification program standard for commissioning, governing, delivering, reviewing and sustaining AIDCF assurance

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AIDCF defines the method. Users and assurance providers apply it. Accountable organisations own risks and decisions. This framework issues no certificate.

Document control

Field	Value
Purpose	Define repeatable AIDCF assurance programs without establishing AIDCF as a certification or accreditation body.
Users	Organisations, customers, assurance providers, internal audit, investors and regulators using AIDCF for bounded decisions.
Inputs	Controls, evidence, workpapers, gates, scores, findings, scenarios and decisions.
Outputs	Charter, plan, assessment package, bounded statement, action plan, reassessment and continuing-assurance records.
Non-certification	No AIDCF certificate, certification mark, accredited status or universal claim is created.
Safety	No program authorises hazardous testing or replaces licensed professional judgment.

Executive thesis

AIDCF-011 converts the AIDCF method into a usable assurance program while preserving the separation between framework ownership, assessment delivery, evidence review, management accountability and any separately regulated certification activity.

Part I - Authority and boundaries

AIDCF-011 standardises programs, not certification.

Element	Program rule
Framework owner	Maintains methodology, schemas and change control.
Program sponsor	Defines and authorises the decision need.
Assessed organisation	Owns capability, evidence access, risks and actions.
Assurance provider	Performs work under its own professional and contractual authority.
Decision authority	Issues or withholds a bounded conclusion.
Permitted wording	Assessed using AIDCF; AIDCF-aligned assessment; provider-issued AIDCF-aligned assurance statement.
Prohibited wording	AIDCF Certified; AIDCF Accredited; universal safe/secure/resilient claim.
Separate certification	Any certification scheme is outside this framework and remains the responsibility of a separately governed body.

Part II - Program principles

Programs retain AIDCF constitutional invariants.

Element	Program rule
Capability first	Defined Capability Instance and Service Outcomes.
Evidence gated	Every material claim has evidence or explicit UNKNOWN.
UNKNOWN visible	Missing, stale, inaccessible and conflicting evidence remains non-favourable.
Gate dominance	Critical gates cannot be averaged away.
State distinction	Design, implementation, operation, effectiveness and resilience remain distinct.
Boundary visibility	External and excluded dependencies remain visible.
Safety	Collection and testing are authorised and proportionate.
Competence	Collective technical and assurance competence.
Bounded conclusion	Scope, state, time, evidence and limitations.
Reassessment	Material change can suspend prior reliance.

Part III - Program models

AIDCF supports multiple assurance relationships.

Element	Program rule
First-party	Organisation self-assessment for readiness and improvement.
Co-sourced	Management and provider share work with explicit responsibility split.
Second-party	Customer, investor or contracting party assesses a provider for a decision.
Independent third-party	Provider performs work and issues its own bounded statement.
Regulatory support	Structures evidence and analysis; does not determine legal compliance unless separately authorised.
Diligence	Bounded review for transaction, finance, capacity or outsourcing.
Internal audit	May use AIDCF under its existing charter and standards.
Continuing assurance	Claim-specific evidence refresh and event-driven reassessment, not universal continuous assurance.

Part IV - Assurance levels

Levels describe depth, not certification grades.

Element	Program rule
AL0 Discovery	Inventory and decision discovery; no conclusion.
AL1 Readiness	Scope, ownership, applicability and evidence readiness.
AL2 Design	Requirements, architecture and safeguard design.
AL3 Implementation	Reconciliation to implemented/as-built state.
AL4 Operational	Representative operation, monitoring, maintenance and incidents.
AL5 Effectiveness and resilience	Safeguard effectiveness, failure containment and recovery.
AL6 Continuing	Refresh approved claims, evidence, gates and triggers.

Part V - Assessment types

Select the assessment type from the decision question and lifecycle event.

Element	Program rule
Baseline	Initial capability-wide understanding.
Readiness	Preparation for deployment or deeper assurance.
Design	Pre-build/architecture decision support.
Implementation	As-built, commissioning or handover.
Operational	Current operating effectiveness over a declared period.
Resilience	Failure, degraded state, containment and recovery.
Major change	Delta assessment after material change.
Incident triggered	Impact on prior claims and residual state.
Periodic	Planned reassessment of defined claims/gates.
Continuous	Evidence and trigger monitoring for approved assertions.

Part VI - Program lifecycle

The program lifecycle governs AIDCF-009 execution.

Element	Program rule
P0 Need	Business decision, intended users and authority.
P1 Charter	Decision question, capability, outcomes and program model.
P2 Scope/profile	Boundary, level, controls, states, gates and exclusions.
P3 Provider	Competence, independence, conflicts and rules of engagement.
P4 Plan	Evidence, methods, samples, tests, safety and reviews.
P5 Execute	AIDCF-009 fieldwork and workpapers.
P6 Evaluate	Findings, scenarios, gates, UNKNOWN, scores and recommendation.
P7 Review	Technical and independent challenge.
P8 Decide/report	Accountable decision and bounded statement.
P9 Improve/sustain	Actions, closure evidence, validity, monitoring and reassessment.

Part VII - Governance roles

Program governance separates assessment from management responsibility.

Element	Program rule
Steering group	Approves charter, scope, changes and unresolved conflicts.
Capability owner	Owns outcomes, risks and actions.
Program lead	Coordinates program design and delivery.
Lead assessor	Directs assessment and integration.
Domain specialists	Approve technical methods and conclusions.
Evidence lead	Controls requirements, provenance and disclosure.
Independent reviewer	Challenges method, evidence, gates and wording.
Decision authority	Issues or withholds conclusion.
Action owners	Deliver remediation and closure evidence.
Tool owner	Implements workflows without hidden authority.

Part VIII - Independence

Safeguards depend on intended reliance and provider model.

Element	Program rule
Self-assessment	Management review plus independent challenge for material gates.
Co-sourced	Separate preparation, testing, evaluation and review.
Second-party	Disclose commissioner, purpose and access constraints.
Independent provider	Apply provider conflict, quality and liability rules.
Prior advisory work	Address self-review threat or restrict scope.
Outcome-contingent fees	Prohibited for assurance conclusions.
Management decisions	Assessors do not accept risk or operate controls for management.
Specialist reliance	Record competence, scope and responsibility.

Part IX - Competence

AIDCF states competence expectations but does not accredit people or firms.

Element	Program rule
Program lead	Program governance, intended use and stakeholders.
Lead assessor	AIDCF, assurance, evidence, gates and decisions.
Electrical	Power architecture, protection and testing.
Mechanical	Cooling, thermal, fluid and recovery.
Compute	AI/HPC architecture, firmware and recovery.
Storage/network	Integrity, performance, fabrics, failover and restore.
Operations/resilience	Reliability, incident, continuity and crisis.
OT/security	Identity, authority, control plane and response.
Evidence/data	Provenance, integrity, analytics, privacy and custody.
Independent reviewer	Senior assurance competence and impartial challenge.

Part X - Scoping

Ambiguous boundaries cannot support strong reliance.

Element	Program rule
Capability	Identity, owner, lifecycle and architecture baseline.
Service outcomes	Function, tolerance, duration, state and consequence.
Boundary	Physical, logical, organisational, provider and temporal.
Operating states	Normal, maintenance, degraded, emergency, recovery and transition.
Controls	Applicable AIDCF control and assurance-dimension profile.
Gates	Applicable CG-01 to CG-15 and evidence floors.
Dependencies	Internal, external, shared, common-mode and recovery.
Exclusions	Visible rationale and residual effect.
Intended users	Named users and permitted reliance.
Materiality	Decision-specific consequence and escalation.

Part XI - Evidence and testing

Programs apply AIDCF-008 and AIDCF-009 without changing source authority.

Element	Program rule
Evidence plan	Assertion-specific classes, quality, sufficiency and timing.
Intake	Identity, source, collector, custodian, classification and integrity.
Conflict	Retain supporting, challenging and qualifying evidence.
Derived evidence	Source lineage, transformation, assumptions and review.
Sampling	Population, strata, method, expansion and limitation.
Testing	Authority, initial state, method, abort and restoration.
Safety	Safety authority can stop work.
Restricted evidence	Alternative evidence or explicit UNKNOWN.
Retention	Legal, contractual, audit and decision lineage.
Disclosure	Minimum necessary information with protection and redaction.

Part XII - Evaluation

AIDCF-010 supports synthesis while authority retains the decision.

Element	Program rule
Control results	Separate design, implementation, operation, effectiveness and resilience.
Findings	Condition, criterion, evidence, cause and consequence.
Scenarios	Propagation, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Gates	Independent PASS, FAIL, UNKNOWN or approved N/A.
UNKNOWN	Materiality and decision ceiling.
Scores	Raw/adjusted indicators, coverage and confidence.
Recommendation	Controlling reasons and prohibited higher states.
Review	Technical and independent challenge.
Decision	Controlled AIDCF-010 state.
Conditions	Named, owned, time-bound and evidence-based.

Part XIII - Assurance statement

The output is a bounded statement, not a certificate.

Element	Program rule
Issuer	Organisation/provider issuing under its own authority.
Users/use	Named audience and decision.
Subject	Capability Instance and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Boundary, states, period, profile and level.
Criteria	Applicable AIDCF artifact versions.
Methods	Assessment type and material methods.
Evidence	Coverage, sufficiency, confidence and restrictions.
Gates	Statuses and controlling effects.
Conclusion	Controlled AIDCF-010 decision state.
Limitations	UNKNOWN, exclusions and assumptions.
Validity	Point/period and reassessment triggers.
Non-certification	No AIDCF certification, accreditation or guarantee.

Part XIV - Prohibited claims

Prevent understatement of limits and overstatement of AIDCF authority.

Element	Program rule
AIDCF Certified	Prohibited.
AIDCF Accredited	Prohibited.
Compliant with all laws	Prohibited unless separately authorised and evidenced.
Safe/secure/resilient universally	Prohibited guarantee.
Continuous assurance universally	Prohibited unless specific monitored claims and blind spots are defined.
Pass based on score	Prohibited when gates or UNKNOWN control.
Engineering approval	AIDCF does not replace it.
Framework-owner endorsement	Not implied by use.
Public ranking	Requires separate approved cohort method.
Transfer of assurance	Requires applicability across capability, boundary, state and time.

Part XV - Reporting

Different reports use the same underlying evidence and decision.

Element	Program rule
Executive report	Outcomes, gates, material findings, UNKNOWN, decision and actions.
Technical report	Scope, methods, controls, scenarios, evidence and rationale.
Evidence register	Requirements, objects, quality, sufficiency and restrictions.
Gate register	Applicability, evidence, status, effect and closure.
Findings register	Cause, consequence, action and closure criteria.
Assurance statement	Bounded conclusion for intended users.
Management response	Owned action/risk decisions separate from assessor conclusion.
AITG package	Versioned graph records and native conclusions.
Public summary	Optional and never stronger than full report.

Part XVI - Validity and reassessment

No conclusion remains valid indefinitely by default.

Element	Program rule
Validity	Point-in-time/period, conditions and evidence basis.
Evidence expiry	Mandatory evidence expiry triggers review.
Material change	Architecture, capacity, configuration, supplier or ownership.
Incident	May suspend affected claims.
Gate change	FAIL/critical UNKNOWN triggers review.
Closure	Requires evidence and reassessment.
Periodic review	Set by risk, freshness and reliance.
Supersession	Preserve prior history.
Withdrawal	Issuer removes conclusion when reliance is no longer defensible.

Part XVII - Continuing assurance

Continuing assurance is claim-specific monitoring plus human decision.

Element	Program rule
Baseline	Initial defensible assessment.
Source register	Authoritative sources, owners and health.
Monitored claims	Explicit propositions, states and dependencies.
Refresh	Evidence validation cadence.
Triggers	Change, incident, threshold, missing data, conflict and gate event.
Blind spots	Source outage and uncovered states visible.
Human review	Automation proposes; authority approves material status.
Decision state	Maintain, condition, suspend, withdraw or reassess.
Snapshot	Immutable evidence, rules and lineage.

Part XVIII - Quality and challenge

Quality protects conclusions from unsupported or commercial pressure.

Element	Program rule
Quality plan	Review points and technical approvals.
Hot review	Before material conclusion.
Cold review	Post-issuance sample.
Consultation	Resolve specialist disagreement.
Evidence challenge	Assertion-to-evidence trace and contrary evidence.
Appeal	Challenge facts/method, not negotiate outcome.
Complaint	Conduct, confidentiality and process concerns.
Correction	Material error triggers corrected/superseding report.
Conflict register	Commercial, management and reviewer conflicts.

Part XIX - Data and graph

Assurance does not justify overcollection or exposure of infrastructure paths.

Element	Program rule
Minimisation	Collect only for precise assertions.
Authorisation	Source-owner approval.
Classification	Protect architecture, credentials, controls and dependencies.
Segregation	Separate client, provider and public packages.
Redaction	Preserve limitations when details withheld.
Retention/deletion	Preserve obligations and lineage.
Graph security	Restrict sensitive paths and exports.
AI use	AI-derived material is candidate, lineage-linked and reviewed.
Native conclusions	AIDCF and AITG decisions remain separate.

Part XX - Commercial deployment

AIDCF supports services and products without certification claims.

Element	Program rule
Readiness review	Profile, evidence gaps and roadmap.
Design assurance	Architecture and safeguard design.
Deployment assurance	Implementation, commissioning and handover.
Operational assurance	Representative operating evidence and gates.
Resilience assurance	Scenario, containment, recovery and exercise.
Continuing assurance	Subscription/cadence for approved monitored claims.
Second-party review	Supplier/customer decision support.
Platform subscription	Workflow, evidence and graph; human authority remains.
Benchmarking	Comparable cohort analytics.
Method licence	Use under terms; no implied endorsement.

Program stage gates

Advance only when exit criteria are met or limitations remain explicit.

Element	Program rule
PG-0 Authorise	Need, sponsor, users and authority.
PG-1 Charter	Question, capability, outcomes and model.
PG-2 Scope	Boundary, profile, level, gates and exclusions.
PG-3 Provider	Competence, independence and rules.
PG-4 Plan	Evidence, methods, safety and reviews.
PG-5 Complete	Fieldwork complete or UNKNOWN visible.
PG-6 Technical review	Domain conclusions and gates approved.
PG-7 Independent review	Package and wording challenged.
PG-8 Issue	Decision and statement authorised.
PG-9 Sustain	Actions, evidence custody and triggers active.

AL0 Program Profile - Discovery

Depth profile for discovery.

Element	Program rule
Purpose	Discovery
Permitted claim	No assurance conclusion
Entry	Approved charter, capability, outcomes and scope.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 floor appropriate to claim.
Methods	AIDCF-009 procedures appropriate to state and consequence.
Gates	All applicable gates; no averaging.
Scoring	AIDCF-010 indicators, coverage and confidence.
Outputs	Report, registers, statement, actions and triggers.
Decision	Controlled AIDCF-010 state.
Validity	Explicit period/point and reassessment triggers.

AL1 Program Profile - Readiness

Depth profile for readiness.

Element	Program rule
Purpose	Readiness
Permitted claim	Readiness conclusion only
Entry	Approved charter, capability, outcomes and scope.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 floor appropriate to claim.
Methods	AIDCF-009 procedures appropriate to state and consequence.
Gates	All applicable gates; no averaging.
Scoring	AIDCF-010 indicators, coverage and confidence.
Outputs	Report, registers, statement, actions and triggers.
Decision	Controlled AIDCF-010 state.
Validity	Explicit period/point and reassessment triggers.

AL2 Program Profile - Design

Depth profile for design.

Element	Program rule
Purpose	Design
Permitted claim	Design assurance only
Entry	Approved charter, capability, outcomes and scope.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 floor appropriate to claim.
Methods	AIDCF-009 procedures appropriate to state and consequence.
Gates	All applicable gates; no averaging.
Scoring	AIDCF-010 indicators, coverage and confidence.
Outputs	Report, registers, statement, actions and triggers.
Decision	Controlled AIDCF-010 state.
Validity	Explicit period/point and reassessment triggers.

AL3 Program Profile - Implementation

Depth profile for implementation.

Element	Program rule
Purpose	Implementation
Permitted claim	Implementation assurance
Entry	Approved charter, capability, outcomes and scope.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 floor appropriate to claim.
Methods	AIDCF-009 procedures appropriate to state and consequence.
Gates	All applicable gates; no averaging.
Scoring	AIDCF-010 indicators, coverage and confidence.
Outputs	Report, registers, statement, actions and triggers.
Decision	Controlled AIDCF-010 state.
Validity	Explicit period/point and reassessment triggers.

AL4 Program Profile - Operational

Depth profile for operational.

Element	Program rule
Purpose	Operational
Permitted claim	Operational assurance over declared period
Entry	Approved charter, capability, outcomes and scope.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 floor appropriate to claim.
Methods	AIDCF-009 procedures appropriate to state and consequence.
Gates	All applicable gates; no averaging.
Scoring	AIDCF-010 indicators, coverage and confidence.
Outputs	Report, registers, statement, actions and triggers.
Decision	Controlled AIDCF-010 state.
Validity	Explicit period/point and reassessment triggers.

AL5 Program Profile - Effectiveness/resilience

Depth profile for effectiveness/resilience.

Element	Program rule
Purpose	Effectiveness/resilience
Permitted claim	Bounded resilience assurance
Entry	Approved charter, capability, outcomes and scope.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 floor appropriate to claim.
Methods	AIDCF-009 procedures appropriate to state and consequence.
Gates	All applicable gates; no averaging.
Scoring	AIDCF-010 indicators, coverage and confidence.
Outputs	Report, registers, statement, actions and triggers.
Decision	Controlled AIDCF-010 state.
Validity	Explicit period/point and reassessment triggers.

AL6 Program Profile - Continuing

Depth profile for continuing.

Element	Program rule
Purpose	Continuing
Permitted claim	Current designated claims only
Entry	Approved charter, capability, outcomes and scope.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 floor appropriate to claim.
Methods	AIDCF-009 procedures appropriate to state and consequence.
Gates	All applicable gates; no averaging.
Scoring	AIDCF-010 indicators, coverage and confidence.
Outputs	Report, registers, statement, actions and triggers.
Decision	Controlled AIDCF-010 state.
Validity	Explicit period/point and reassessment triggers.

GOV Domain Program Profile - Governance, Accountability and Assurance Direction

Program coverage for authority, decisions, policy and impartiality.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-13; CG-14
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

CAP Domain Program Profile - AI Capability, Service Outcome and Demand Management

Program coverage for capability, outcomes, demand and envelope.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-01; CG-02
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

DEP Domain Program Profile - Dependency, Concentration and External Reliance

Program coverage for dependencies, common modes, providers and concentration.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-03; CG-12
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

PHY Domain Program Profile - Physical Site, Building and Security

Program coverage for site, structure, zoning, access and life safety.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-02; CG-04
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

POW Domain Program Profile - Electrical Power and Energy Continuity

Program coverage for utility, generation, UPS, distribution and recovery.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-05
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

THM Domain Program Profile - Cooling, Thermal and Fluid

Program coverage for thermal capacity, cooling, fluids and recovery.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-06
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

ENV Domain Program Profile - Environmental and Resource Performance

Program coverage for conditions, energy, water, waste and climate continuity.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-02; CG-04
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

CMP Domain Program Profile - AI Compute Infrastructure

Program coverage for compute, clusters, capacity, compatibility and recovery.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-08
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

STO Domain Program Profile - AI Storage and Data

Program coverage for performance, integrity, protection and recovery.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-08; CG-10
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

NET Domain Program Profile - AI Network and Interconnect

Program coverage for fabrics, congestion, optics and observability.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-08
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

OPS Domain Program Profile - Building Operations and Service Management

Program coverage for staffing, work, maintenance, incidents and change.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-07; CG-13; CG-14
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

RES Domain Program Profile - Resilience, Continuity and Recovery

Program coverage for containment, continuity, recovery and crisis.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-09; CG-10
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

SUP Domain Program Profile - Supply Chain, OEM and Ecosystem

Program coverage for supplier, provenance, updates, spares and support.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-03; CG-13
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

SEC Domain Program Profile - Digital, OT and Control-Plane Security

Program coverage for identity, authority, segmentation, detection and automation.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-07; CG-15
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

EVA Domain Program Profile - Evidence, Assessment and Assurance

Program coverage for evidence, execution, findings, gates and reassessment.

Element	Program rule
Decision link	Capability and Service Outcomes.
Scope	Assets, functions, providers, interfaces, states and dependencies.
Depth	AL0-AL6 only for evidenced claim depth.
Methods	Review, interview, inspection, analytics and safe testing.
Evidence	AIDCF-008 provenance, quality, sufficiency and conflict.
Gates	CG-11; CG-12
Scenarios	Adverse paths, safeguards, residual state and recovery.
Outputs	Results, findings, UNKNOWN, gates and domain conclusion.
Review	Competent specialist and independent review where material.
Reassessment	Architecture, capacity, provider, incident and evidence triggers.

Program Playbook - Readiness

Execution playbook for readiness program.

Step	Required activity
1	Define decision and intended users.
2	Define capability, outcomes, scope, states and profile.
3	Select level, gates and evidence depth.
4	Appoint provider/team and assess competence/independence.
5	Approve evidence, methods, sampling, safety and review plan.
6	Execute AIDCF-009; preserve UNKNOWN/conflict.
7	Apply AIDCF-010 constraints.
8	Complete technical and independent review.
9	Issue bounded statement without certification language.
10	Activate actions, triggers and reassessment.

Program Playbook - Design assurance

Execution playbook for design assurance program.

Step	Required activity
1	Define decision and intended users.
2	Define capability, outcomes, scope, states and profile.
3	Select level, gates and evidence depth.
4	Appoint provider/team and assess competence/independence.
5	Approve evidence, methods, sampling, safety and review plan.
6	Execute AIDCF-009; preserve UNKNOWN/conflict.
7	Apply AIDCF-010 constraints.
8	Complete technical and independent review.
9	Issue bounded statement without certification language.
10	Activate actions, triggers and reassessment.

Program Playbook - Deployment assurance

Execution playbook for deployment assurance program.

Step	Required activity
1	Define decision and intended users.
2	Define capability, outcomes, scope, states and profile.
3	Select level, gates and evidence depth.
4	Appoint provider/team and assess competence/independence.
5	Approve evidence, methods, sampling, safety and review plan.
6	Execute AIDCF-009; preserve UNKNOWN/conflict.
7	Apply AIDCF-010 constraints.
8	Complete technical and independent review.
9	Issue bounded statement without certification language.
10	Activate actions, triggers and reassessment.

Program Playbook - Operational assurance

Execution playbook for operational assurance program.

Step	Required activity
1	Define decision and intended users.
2	Define capability, outcomes, scope, states and profile.
3	Select level, gates and evidence depth.
4	Appoint provider/team and assess competence/independence.
5	Approve evidence, methods, sampling, safety and review plan.
6	Execute AIDCF-009; preserve UNKNOWN/conflict.
7	Apply AIDCF-010 constraints.
8	Complete technical and independent review.
9	Issue bounded statement without certification language.
10	Activate actions, triggers and reassessment.

Program Playbook - Resilience assurance

Execution playbook for resilience assurance program.

Step	Required activity
1	Define decision and intended users.
2	Define capability, outcomes, scope, states and profile.
3	Select level, gates and evidence depth.
4	Appoint provider/team and assess competence/independence.
5	Approve evidence, methods, sampling, safety and review plan.
6	Execute AIDCF-009; preserve UNKNOWN/conflict.
7	Apply AIDCF-010 constraints.
8	Complete technical and independent review.
9	Issue bounded statement without certification language.
10	Activate actions, triggers and reassessment.

Program Playbook - Major change

Execution playbook for major change program.

Step	Required activity
1	Define decision and intended users.
2	Define capability, outcomes, scope, states and profile.
3	Select level, gates and evidence depth.
4	Appoint provider/team and assess competence/independence.
5	Approve evidence, methods, sampling, safety and review plan.
6	Execute AIDCF-009; preserve UNKNOWN/conflict.
7	Apply AIDCF-010 constraints.
8	Complete technical and independent review.
9	Issue bounded statement without certification language.
10	Activate actions, triggers and reassessment.

Program Playbook - Incident-triggered

Execution playbook for incident-triggered program.

Step	Required activity
1	Define decision and intended users.
2	Define capability, outcomes, scope, states and profile.
3	Select level, gates and evidence depth.
4	Appoint provider/team and assess competence/independence.
5	Approve evidence, methods, sampling, safety and review plan.
6	Execute AIDCF-009; preserve UNKNOWN/conflict.
7	Apply AIDCF-010 constraints.
8	Complete technical and independent review.
9	Issue bounded statement without certification language.
10	Activate actions, triggers and reassessment.

Program Playbook - Second-party

Execution playbook for second-party program.

Step	Required activity
1	Define decision and intended users.
2	Define capability, outcomes, scope, states and profile.
3	Select level, gates and evidence depth.
4	Appoint provider/team and assess competence/independence.
5	Approve evidence, methods, sampling, safety and review plan.
6	Execute AIDCF-009; preserve UNKNOWN/conflict.
7	Apply AIDCF-010 constraints.
8	Complete technical and independent review.
9	Issue bounded statement without certification language.
10	Activate actions, triggers and reassessment.

Program Playbook - Independent-provider

Execution playbook for independent-provider program.

Step	Required activity
1	Define decision and intended users.
2	Define capability, outcomes, scope, states and profile.
3	Select level, gates and evidence depth.
4	Appoint provider/team and assess competence/independence.
5	Approve evidence, methods, sampling, safety and review plan.
6	Execute AIDCF-009; preserve UNKNOWN/conflict.
7	Apply AIDCF-010 constraints.
8	Complete technical and independent review.
9	Issue bounded statement without certification language.
10	Activate actions, triggers and reassessment.

Program Playbook - Continuing assurance

Execution playbook for continuing assurance program.

Step	Required activity
1	Define decision and intended users.
2	Define capability, outcomes, scope, states and profile.
3	Select level, gates and evidence depth.
4	Appoint provider/team and assess competence/independence.
5	Approve evidence, methods, sampling, safety and review plan.
6	Execute AIDCF-009; preserve UNKNOWN/conflict.
7	Apply AIDCF-010 constraints.
8	Complete technical and independent review.
9	Issue bounded statement without certification language.
10	Activate actions, triggers and reassessment.

Statement Template - Self-assessment conclusion

A bounded AIDCF-aligned conclusion, not a certificate.

Element	Program rule
Issuer/authority	Named issuer and authority.
Users/use	Audience and decision purpose.
Capability/outcomes	Defined subject.
Scope	Boundary, states, period, profile and level.
Criteria	AIDCF artifact versions.
Responsibilities	Management, assessor, reviewer and authority.
Methods	Material methods, sampling and tests.
Evidence	Coverage, sufficiency, confidence and restrictions.
Gates	Statuses and effects.
Scores	Indicators, coverage and confidence.
Conclusion	Controlled AIDCF-010 state.
Limitations	UNKNOWN, exclusions and assumptions.
Validity	Conditions and triggers.
Non-certification	No certification, accreditation or guarantee.

Statement Template - Co-sourced assurance statement

A bounded AIDCF-aligned conclusion, not a certificate.

Element	Program rule
Issuer/authority	Named issuer and authority.
Users/use	Audience and decision purpose.
Capability/outcomes	Defined subject.
Scope	Boundary, states, period, profile and level.
Criteria	AIDCF artifact versions.
Responsibilities	Management, assessor, reviewer and authority.
Methods	Material methods, sampling and tests.
Evidence	Coverage, sufficiency, confidence and restrictions.
Gates	Statuses and effects.
Scores	Indicators, coverage and confidence.
Conclusion	Controlled AIDCF-010 state.
Limitations	UNKNOWN, exclusions and assumptions.
Validity	Conditions and triggers.
Non-certification	No certification, accreditation or guarantee.

Statement Template - Second-party assessment statement

A bounded AIDCF-aligned conclusion, not a certificate.

Element	Program rule
Issuer/authority	Named issuer and authority.
Users/use	Audience and decision purpose.
Capability/outcomes	Defined subject.
Scope	Boundary, states, period, profile and level.
Criteria	AIDCF artifact versions.
Responsibilities	Management, assessor, reviewer and authority.
Methods	Material methods, sampling and tests.
Evidence	Coverage, sufficiency, confidence and restrictions.
Gates	Statuses and effects.
Scores	Indicators, coverage and confidence.
Conclusion	Controlled AIDCF-010 state.
Limitations	UNKNOWN, exclusions and assumptions.
Validity	Conditions and triggers.
Non-certification	No certification, accreditation or guarantee.

Statement Template - Independent third-party statement

A bounded AIDCF-aligned conclusion, not a certificate.

Element	Program rule
Issuer/authority	Named issuer and authority.
Users/use	Audience and decision purpose.
Capability/outcomes	Defined subject.
Scope	Boundary, states, period, profile and level.
Criteria	AIDCF artifact versions.
Responsibilities	Management, assessor, reviewer and authority.
Methods	Material methods, sampling and tests.
Evidence	Coverage, sufficiency, confidence and restrictions.
Gates	Statuses and effects.
Scores	Indicators, coverage and confidence.
Conclusion	Controlled AIDCF-010 state.
Limitations	UNKNOWN, exclusions and assumptions.
Validity	Conditions and triggers.
Non-certification	No certification, accreditation or guarantee.

Statement Template - Continuing assurance update

A bounded AIDCF-aligned conclusion, not a certificate.

Element	Program rule
Issuer/authority	Named issuer and authority.
Users/use	Audience and decision purpose.
Capability/outcomes	Defined subject.
Scope	Boundary, states, period, profile and level.
Criteria	AIDCF artifact versions.
Responsibilities	Management, assessor, reviewer and authority.
Methods	Material methods, sampling and tests.
Evidence	Coverage, sufficiency, confidence and restrictions.
Gates	Statuses and effects.
Scores	Indicators, coverage and confidence.
Conclusion	Controlled AIDCF-010 state.
Limitations	UNKNOWN, exclusions and assumptions.
Validity	Conditions and triggers.
Non-certification	No certification, accreditation or guarantee.

Machine-readable publication package

Tools implement declared workflow and never hidden authority.

Element	Program rule
aidcf-apf-v1.0.json	Program configuration.
program-charter.schema.json	Decision, subject, users and authority.
program-profile.schema.json	Level, type, controls, gates and evidence.
provider-role.schema.json	Competence and independence.
program-plan.schema.json	Methods, safety and reviews.
assurance-statement.schema.json	Bounded statement.
validity-trigger.schema.json	Monitoring and reassessment.
quality-review.schema.json	Review, appeal and correction.
aidcf-program.owl / ttl	Program ontology.
aidcf-program-shapes.ttl	Validation shapes.
conformance-tests	Non-certification, safety and lineage fixtures.

AITG mappings

Program records remain native AIDCF objects.

Element	Program rule
Program	AssuranceProgram
Charter	ProgramCharter
Profile	ProgramProfile
Provider/role	Organisation / Role / ASSIGNED_TO
Capability	CapabilityInstance / ASSURES
Evidence	EvidencePackage / SUPPORTS
Assessment	Assessment / EXECUTES
Gate	GateResult / CONSTRAINS
Decision	AssuranceDecision / ISSUED_BY
Statement	AssuranceStatement / REPORTS
Action	Action / REMEDIATES
Trigger	Trigger / REQUIRES_REVIEW
Supersession	SUPERSEDES

Template - Program Charter

Complete all mandatory fields.

Element	Program rule
programId	
decisionQuestion	
intendedUsers	
capability	
outcomes	
model	
type	
level	
authority	
constraints	
approvals	

Template - Program Profile

Complete all mandatory fields.

Element	Program rule
scope	
boundary	
states	
controls	
gates	
evidenceDepth	
methods	
outputs	
validity	

Template - Provider Record

Complete all mandatory fields.

Element	Program rule
provider	
roles	
competence	
conflicts	
safeguards	
responsibilities	
authority	

Template - Program Plan

Complete all mandatory fields.

Element	Program rule
workstreams	
evidence	
interviews	
inspections	
samples	
tests	
safety	
reviews	
stageGates	

Template - Assurance Statement

Complete all mandatory fields.

Element	Program rule
issuer	
users	
subject	
scope	
criteria	
responsibilities	
methods	
evidence	
gates	
scores	
conclusion	
limitations	
validity	
authorisation	

Template - Continuing Assurance

Complete all mandatory fields.

Element	Program rule
claims	
sources	
thresholds	
refresh	
blindSpots	
triggers	
review	
decisionState	
snapshot	

Template - Quality Review

Complete all mandatory fields.

Element	Program rule
reviewId	
ryth	
scope	
samples	
technicalApprovals	
challenges	
dispositions	
appeals	
corrections	
release	

Conformance validation

Programs pass non-certification, safety, evidence and lineage tests.

ID	Validation
APF-VAL-001	No certification/accreditation claim.
APF-VAL-002	Question, users, capability and outcomes explicit.
APF-VAL-003	Model, type and level approved.
APF-VAL-004	Scope, states, dependencies and exclusions visible.
APF-VAL-005	Controls and gates defined.
APF-VAL-006	Evidence depth matches claim depth.
APF-VAL-007	Competence and independence assessed.
APF-VAL-008	Management and assessor responsibilities separate.
APF-VAL-009	Safety and stop criteria documented.
APF-VAL-010	UNKNOWN/conflict visible.
APF-VAL-011	Scores do not override gates.
APF-VAL-012	Statement uses controlled decision language.
APF-VAL-013	Validity and triggers stated.
APF-VAL-014	Continuing assurance limited to designated claims.
APF-VAL-015	Tooling cannot approve decisions automatically.
APF-VAL-016	Corrections preserve history.
APF-VAL-017	Public summary not stronger than report.

Review and release gates

Draft requires multidisciplinary pilot and review.

Reviewer/pilot	Status
Methodology author	Pending
Assurance specialist	Pending
Independent provider reviewer	Pending
Internal audit reviewer	Pending
Engineering reviewers	Pending
AI/HPC reviewer	Pending
OT/security reviewer	Pending
Evidence/privacy/legal reviewer	Pending
Second-party reviewer	Pending
AITG/tooling reviewer	Pending
First-party pilot	Pending
Co-sourced pilot	Pending
Third-party pilot	Pending
Continuing-assurance pilot	Pending
Public release	Pending

Final doctrine

AIDCF-011 enables disciplined assurance programs without presenting AIDCF as a certifying or accrediting body. The issuer remains responsible for competence, independence, professional obligations and the bounded statement issued. The assessed organisation remains responsible for the capability, risks, controls, actions and decisions.